

THE \$2,500 CASE

What this is: the market research, the value maths, and the exact way to anchor a \$2,500-a-month retainer with Jitty tomorrow — with a walk-away line you can actually hold. Sections tagged **SHOW JITTY** can go straight into his proposal; sections tagged **YOUR EYES ONLY** are your playbook.

Prepared for Stalin · Friday 11 September 2026 · Pitch: Saturday 12 September

READ THIS FIRST

THE SHORT VERSION

1. **Open with his numbers, not yours.** Since the direction you gave him the week of 6 July: reach 20× on Facebook and 30× on Instagram, calls from Google 3.5×, followers 485 → 1,162, one reel at 125,000 views. Price comes last, after he's agreed what it's worth.
2. **\$2,500 is not expensive — it's under market for the scope.** Bought in pieces at Australian freelance rates, what you're proposing costs \$5,200–9,600 a month. Auto-specific agencies (US) sit at \$1,500–6,000/mo *before* video. You are selling a ~50% discount, not a premium.
3. **Break-even is one used car a month.** Or eleven Standard services. Or one panel job plus six services. Say it in cars, not dollars — that's the unit Jitty thinks in.
4. **Anchor from the top.** Show a \$3,800 option first, then \$2,500 as "the one that fits you", then a deliberately thin \$1,500 that is obviously a downgrade. He should feel he's choosing the middle, not being sold the top.
5. **Lead with what he's already received.** The website, the booking flow, the tracking, the playbook, the calendar tool — roughly \$8–12k of work at market rates, delivered on trust. The trial has already run. You're not asking him to gamble; you're asking him to stop getting it free.
6. **The walk-away is a scope line, not a threat.** Below \$2,500 you cannot run a *system* — only posts. And posts are exactly what he has now. Say that plainly, once, and mean it.

WHAT CHANGED WHEN HE FOLLOWED THE DIRECTION

The week of **6 July** you gave Jitty the video direction. Nothing else changed — same shop, same phone, same cars. Everything below is *his* numbers, before and after that week, read straight from Meta Business Suite and his Google Business Profile on 11–12 September.

INSTAGRAM + FACEBOOK	BEFORE 1 JAN – 5 JUL	AFTER 6 JUL – 10 SEP	CHANGE
Posts per week	3.6	6.5	1.8×
Reels posted	8	37	4.6×
Average reach per post (viral reel excluded)	44	430	10×
Facebook reach	2,869	58,588	20×
Instagram reach	3,084	92,452	30×
New Instagram followers	+55	+811	now 1,162
New Facebook followers	+8	+271	now 459

The "before" window is 186 days; the "after" is 67. The after column is *bigger in a third of the time*. Every one of the year's top-ten posts by reach is a reel. The best photo post of the year reached 450 people.

Google — the numbers a mechanic respects

GOOGLE BUSINESS PROFILE, MONTHLY AVERAGE	APR – JUN	JUL – AUG	CHANGE
Calls from the profile	4.3	15	3.5×
Website clicks from the profile	15	30.5	2×
Profile interactions	78	106	+36%
Direction requests	59	61	flat
Google reviews	20 × 5.0★	26 × 5.0★	+6
Posts on the Google profile	0	10	from nothing

Directions flat is the honest part and it's worth saying: people already knew where the shop was. What changed is how many *rang*. 1,115 people saw the profile in Google search in August alone.

The reel — 8 September

125K

views in 3 days —
"Looking for a family
car?" — 69K Instagram,
56K Facebook. A typical
reel: a few hundred

643

new followers from one
post. The account had
485 the day before

99%

of viewers were not
followers — pure
discovery, delivered by
the algorithm, not by
the page

520

shares. 28-second
average watch on a
1:25 reel. Skip rate
lower than Instagram's
own benchmark

Then the turn: "125,000 people watched. 1,900 visited the profile. *Forty-three* came to the website. And what's posted for next week? Nothing. That's not a video problem — the video was brilliant. It's a system problem. 643 people just followed you and they're waiting for the next one."

The honest read — say this before he does

- **The viral reel was national and diaspora, not local.** Australia was about half the audience; South Australia wasn't in its top ten regions. It built the brand and the follower base — it didn't fill the hoist.
- **The everyday reels are what reach Adelaide.** On the ordinary weekly reels, South Australia is the #1 or top-5 region every time. Those are the ones that book jobs — and they only happen with a cadence.
- **The audience is right:** ~90% men, 25–44. That's who buys a used family car and gets it serviced.
- **What's already in the can:** 21 raw clips from the 25 August shoot and two edited cuts (7 Sep, 11 Sep) — confirm the count before the meeting. "The first fortnight of the system is already shot" is a strong sentence.

WHAT'S IN THE MARKET [SHOW JITTY](#)

WHAT THIS COSTS WHEN YOU BUY IT FROM ANYONE ELSE

Australian 2026 pricing for the pieces you're bundling. Ranges are wide because scope is wide — the number that matters is the last table, where your scope is priced out line by line.

SERVICE (AUSTRALIA, 2026)	TYPICAL PRICE	NOTES
Freelance social media manager, light	\$500–1,500 / mo	Few posts, one or two platforms, no video, no filming

Agency social management, small business	\$1,000–2,000 / mo	Two platforms, graphics + captions, monthly report. Video costs extra
Agency social management with video	\$2,000–8,000 / mo	"Most owners who want it genuinely handled end up in the low thousands"
Social content package (video-led)	from \$2,000 / mo	Vidico's floor for ongoing short-form content
Videographer, day rate	\$800–2,500 / day	Editing billed separately, \$50–110 / hr
Batch of 3–6 short-form videos, one shoot day	\$3,000–8,000	Shot and edited for Instagram / YouTube — a single batch
Editing only, one reel	\$30–150 each	You supply footage; they cut it
UGC creator, per video	\$150–800 each	Beginner to intermediate; established creators \$1,000+
Auto-repair marketing agencies (US)	US\$1,500–6,000 / mo	Shop Marketing Pros: US\$2,899–4,795/mo on 18-month terms. Ad spend on top
In-house social media manager	\$80–95k / yr	≈ \$7,500–8,800 / mo once super and on-costs are added

Your scope, bought in pieces — what he'd pay if he hired each part separately

Build the value in this order in the meeting. Each row is a separate person he'd otherwise have to find, brief, and chase. The point isn't the total — it's that no one else would do all eleven.

#	WHAT YOU'RE PROPOSING (PER MONTH)	WHO HE'D OTHERWISE HIRE	MARKET LOW	MARKET HIGH
1	Video production — 4 half-day shoots at the workshop, 3 reels each, edited	Video production company (Vidico floor is for fewer videos than this)	\$2,000	\$3,000
2	Editing his own videos — the 2 a week Jitty films: cut, captioned, thumbnailed	Freelance editor, \$30–150 per reel × 8	\$300	\$800
3	Weekly used-car inventory video — every car in stock, every week	Videographer, per visit	\$300	\$600
4	Instagram management — daily posting, captions, stories, replying to DMs and comments	Freelance social media manager	\$500	\$1,000
5	Facebook page management — posting, replies, page reviews, events	Same person, second platform	\$300	\$600
6	Community-group system — weekly posts into the Adelaide Indian Community and other groups, with tracked links so we see which group sends customers	Almost no agency offers this	\$200	\$400

7	Photography — at every shoot: cars, work, the workshop, Jitty	Photographer, per visit	\$200	\$400
8	Google Business Profile — photos, posts, review requests, Q&A, keeping details right	Local SEO freelancer	\$300	\$600
9	Website upkeep — listings, prices, booking flow, tracking links	Web developer, retainer	\$300	\$600
10	The system itself — monthly content calendar, 2-week buffer always loaded, scheduling, a weekly check-in with Jitty so nothing depends on him remembering	Account manager / content strategist	\$400	\$800
11	Reporting — fortnightly numbers, what worked, what we change next	Marketing consultant	\$400	\$800
Market total, bought separately		Eleven people, or three agencies	\$5,200	\$9,600
What you're asking		\$2,500 — less than half the market floor		

The sentence for Jitty: "If you rang an agency in Adelaide for exactly this, the cheapest quote you'd get is about five thousand a month — and they'd still send a stranger to film you. I'm asking for half, because I already know your business."

ALREADY DELIVERED [SHOW JITTY](#)

WHAT HE HAS RECEIVED SO FAR — ON TRUST

This is the most persuasive slide you own and you're the only one who can present it. Every line is real, and every line has a market price. He's been getting the trial for free; tomorrow is the day it becomes a partnership.

Website rebuilt — mobile-first, services, used cars, paint & panel, reviews, map, schema **\$3,000–8,000**

Booking flow — date picker, car make / model / year / km, issue description, straight into WhatsApp as a quote-ready lead **\$1,500–3,000**

Service pricing tiers — Basic \$149 / Standard \$229 / Premium \$329, desktop table + phone cards **\$400–800**

Used-car listings — per-car WhatsApp buttons so we know which car every enquiry is about **\$600–1,200**

Google Analytics + tracked links — Instagram, Google, Facebook, groups each measured separately **\$500–1,500**

Booking confirmation + calendar invites — a tool that sends customers a real calendar invite **\$1,000–2,000**

Reel Playbook — the content strategy, ten ready-to-shoot scripts, the standard CTA **\$800–1,500**

Bio-link animation, thumbnails, Google profile + Facebook page links fixed **\$400–900**

Total — delivered before a single invoice **≈ \$8,000–19,000**

Use the low end out loud ("about eight thousand dollars of work") — it's unarguable, and understatement reads as confidence.

THE VALUE MATHS [SHOW JITTY](#)

WHAT \$2,500 HAS TO BRING BACK

This is the section that moves an owner. Not "engagement" — **cars through the door.**

\$82

per day — what \$2,500 / month costs. Less than one hour of workshop labour

1 car

one used-car sale's margin (≈ \$1,500–2,500) covers most or all of the month

11

Standard services at \$229 = \$2,519. Roughly one extra booking every three days

\$5,500

what one *retained* customer is worth over 8 years at Jitty's prices (2 visits / yr × \$229 × 1.5 cars). US benchmark: \$14,000

Break-even, in the units Jitty counts

MIX THAT PAYS FOR THE MONTH	CARS SERVICED	USED CARS SOLD	PANEL JOBS
Service-only	11 Standard	—	—
Balanced (most realistic)	4	1	—

Panel-led	6	—	1 (\$800+ job)
One good week	2	1	1

Everything past that line is profit — and the point of a system is that it doesn't stop at break-even. A customer won by a reel this month is still coming back in 2030. Retention programs alone lift workshop revenue 15–25% a year; shops that run them keep 60–70% of customers instead of watching them drift to whoever's cheaper on Google that week.

Say it as a question: "If this brings you one extra used-car buyer a month, does it pay for itself?" Let him answer. He'll say yes — and now he's made the argument for you.

WHY A SYSTEM, NOT POSTS [SHOW JITTY](#)

THE COMPOUND EFFECT — AND WHY RANDOM POSTING THROWS IT AWAY

What Jitty does now: post when he remembers, get a spike when something lands, nothing follows. That's the pattern that makes owners say "social media doesn't work". It does — but only the parts that *accumulate*.

ASSET	HOW IT COMPOUNDS	WHAT KILLS IT
Content library	Every symptom reel keeps getting found — Instagram, TikTok and Google all index reels as search results now. A "brakes squealing?" video posted in September still books jobs in March.	Random topics with no CTA. Views with nowhere to go.
Followers	Each viral reel converts a slice of viewers into followers who see the <i>next</i> one. 50 reels at 2% is a local audience that shows up for every post.	A viral hit with no next post. The audience arrives and finds an empty room.
Google reviews	91% of consumers say verified reviews drive their confidence. Compared side by side, the mechanic with more reviews wins without the customer thinking about it.	Not asking. Every unreviewed happy customer is a compounding loss.
Google Business Profile	Profiles with 10+ photos get up to 2× the customer actions; photos alone bring 42% more direction requests. 76–88% of local searchers act within 24 hours.	A profile last updated when the shop opened.
The website funnel	Every reel now ends at a door that collects make, model, year, km and the problem before WhatsApp even opens. The door doesn't get tired.	"DM me" — leads lost in a chat thread nobody follows up.

The evidence from content that's measured: consistent programs show ROI climbing year on year (one benchmark set: ~300% at month 12, ~700% at month 24, ~1,100% at month 36) because the old

content is still working while the new content is added. Paid ads stop the moment the money stops; organic content is the only channel where month 18 is cheaper than month 1.

The line: "The family-car reel proved the direction works. It also proved what's missing: 643 new followers and nothing scheduled for them. The system is what I'm selling."

MECHANICS WHO DID IT

SHOW JITTY

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN A WORKSHOP TAKES THIS SERIOUSLY

Royalty Auto Service, St Marys, Georgia. A father-and-son independent shop. Two years of consistent short-form video — not polished, just real repairs explained to camera. Result: customers now drive from Alabama, the Carolinas and Delaware, some staying overnight in a hotel, to get their car fixed at "the shop from YouTube". A third location is opening. Their own advice from the trade press: *simpler topics perform best* (their breakout video was a window reset), and *authenticity beats polish every time*. That's Jitty's exact advantage — he's authentic on camera already.

Australia. The honest picture: no Australian workshop has gone that big on video yet — which is the opportunity, not the caveat. What the local data does show is that the decision is made online: car owners Google first, and the workshop in the top three map results with the best reviews gets the booking. AutoGuru's national "Top Mechanics" list is built on review volume. A Brisbane workshop with only 260 Instagram followers has held a top-5 AutoGuru rating three years running — the lesson being that *local trust signals* (reviews, profile, consistency) matter more than follower counts. Jitty has the 5.0★ rating; the system's job is to point every video at it.

JITTY'S UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

SHOW JITTY

THE COMMUNITY EDGE NO AGENCY CAN COPY

22.8% of Australians speak a language other than English at home. India is now among the top five countries of birth (673,000 people), up 47.9% in five years — the fastest-growing community in the country. Brands that speak to multicultural customers directly see 15–20% higher retention with those customers.

Jitty already gets most of his work from the Adelaide Indian Community groups. An agency would treat that as a footnote. Your system treats it as the core: a Malayalam or Hindi hook line on the reels shared into the groups, in-language captions on the ones that matter, the community-group links

tracked separately so you both see which group sends the customers. Nobody else in Salisbury is doing this. That is the moat.

Frame it as protecting what he built: "The groups are rented land — one admin change and you're gone. The website, the reviews, the followers are yours. I'm moving your customers onto land you own."

PRICING ARCHITECTURE

YOUR EYES ONLY

THREE OPTIONS — BUILT SO HE PICKS THE MIDDLE

People choose the middle. Your job is to make the top credible, the bottom obviously thin, and the middle exactly what you want. The top isn't a decoy — you'd deliver it happily — but it exists so that \$2,500 reads as reasonable rather than as the ceiling.

MAINTAIN

\$1,500 / mo

"Keep the lights on"

- 2 reels a week — *Jitty films*, you edit
- Instagram + Facebook page managed
- Google profile kept current
- Monthly report
- ~~Filming days at the workshop~~
- ~~Weekly used-car video~~
- ~~Community-group system~~
- ~~Website upkeep~~

RECOMMENDED

GROW

\$2,500 / mo

"The system"

- **5 posts a week** — 3 filmed by you at a weekly half-day shoot, 2 by Jitty
- **Weekly used-car inventory video**
- Instagram + Facebook + community groups, daily
- Google profile: photos, posts, review requests
- Photography at every shoot
- Website kept current — listings, prices, booking flow
- 2-week content buffer, always
- Fortnightly report + call

DOMINATE

\$3,800 / mo

"Own Salisbury"

- Everything in Grow
- **In-language pack** — Malayalam / Hindi / Punjabi hooks and captions
- Paid boosting managed (ad spend on top)
- Monthly review-generation campaign to every customer
- Two shoot days a month
- Quarterly strategy session
- 48-hour turnaround on anything

Terms that protect you

- **6-month minimum, price locked.** Content compounds; three months proves nothing and he'll judge it at month two. Say "six months, we review at three" — the review makes the six feel safe.
- **Paid on the 1st, in advance.** Not "end of month". You're funding shoots and tools up front.
- **Ad spend, print, and paid tools are his.** Your fee is your work. Never absorb Meta's bill.
- **Add-ons instead of discounts.** If he wants more than Grow but baulks at Dominate: in-language pack +\$450, extra shoot day +\$450, boosting management +\$400 or 15% of spend. The \$2,500 base never moves; the "more" you want comes from here.
- **What you'll never do:** guarantee virality, guarantee a booking count, or work without the two-week buffer. Say the first two out loud — refusing to promise is what makes the rest believable.

The one number you don't know: his revenue. Australian small businesses spend 7–10% of revenue on marketing; \$2,500 a month sits at 7–10% of \$25–36k a month (\$300–430k a year). If he does that, this is a normal budget. If he does much less — say under \$20k a month — \$2,500 is over 12% and will feel like a bite, and you'll need the used-car margin argument to do the heavy lifting. Try to find out before you quote, even roughly: "How many cars a week do you put through?" × his average ticket gets you close enough.

HOW TO ANCHOR IT

YOUR EYES ONLY

THE ORDER OF THE CONVERSATION

Value-based selling means the price arrives last, after he's already agreed on what it's worth. Don't let the number come up early. If he asks, say "I'll get to that — I want to show you what you're paying for first," and keep going.

- 1 **Open with his numbers.** The before/after tables, on paper, in front of him. Let him find the calls row himself — 4 a month to 15.

"Week of 6 July I gave you a direction. You followed it. Here's what happened — this is your Google, your Instagram, nothing I made up. Reach twenty times. Calls from Google three and a half times. Four hundred and eighty-five followers to eleven hundred."

- 2 Then what he's already got.** Walk the "already delivered" list, out loud, on his phone. Show him the booking flow working. End with the low number.

"And behind that — the website, the booking flow, the tracking, the calendar tool — about eight thousand dollars of work, done on a handshake. I did it because the business deserved it. Now I want to show you what happens when it's a system instead of a favour."

- 3 The turn — name the leak without blaming him.**

"125,000 people watched the family-car reel. Forty-three came to the website. And there's nothing scheduled for next week. The video was brilliant — the problem is there's no system behind it to catch what it caught."

- 4 Ask the break-even question and wait.**

"If this brings you one extra used-car buyer a month — just one — does it pay for itself?" Then say nothing until he answers.

- 5 Give the market number before yours.**

"If you rang an agency for this — filming, editing, five posts a week, the groups, Google, the website — the cheapest quote you'd get is about five thousand a month."

- 6 Present three options, top first.** Slide the sheet across. Describe Dominate in two sentences, then Grow in four, then Maintain in one — dismissively.

"Dominate is where we'd go if you wanted to own the whole area. Grow is the one I've built for you — it's the system, everything we talked about. Maintain is just me editing what you film — it's what you have now with a nicer finish."

- 7 Say the price once, then stop talking.**

"Grow is two and a half thousand a month, six months, we review at three." Silence. The first person to speak loses. Let him.

When he pushes back

"That's a lot of money."

Agree, then reframe the unit. "It is. It's also eighty-two dollars a day — less than an hour on the hoist. And it's half what anyone else would charge for the same thing. What I'm asking is whether one extra car a month is worth eighty-two dollars a day."

"I get my customers from the Facebook groups anyway."

Don't argue — absorb it. "You do, and the groups are in the plan — every reel goes into them, with a link that shows us which group sends people. But the groups are rented. One admin change and you're gone. Everything I'm building — the reviews, the followers, the website — is yours."

"Can't I just keep doing it myself?"

Price his time. "You can. It's ten hours a week done properly, and your hour is worth more on a car than on a phone. Ten hours of your labour a week is six thousand dollars a month. I'm cheaper than you are."

"Can we do three months and see?"

Hold six, give the review. "Three months is exactly long enough to decide it isn't working before it's had a chance to. Six months, and at three we sit down with the numbers — if they're not moving, I'll tell you first."

"Can you do it for two thousand?"

Trade scope, never price. "I can do two thousand — that's Maintain plus one shoot a month. What comes out is the weekly used-car video and the groups system. Which of those do you want to lose?" He won't want to lose either. That's the point.

THE WALK-AWAY LINE: "BELOW THIS IT'S NOT A SYSTEM, IT'S POSTS — AND POSTS ARE WHAT YOU'VE GOT NOW. I'D RATHER **NOT DO IT** THAN DO IT IN A WAY THAT LETS YOU SAY SOCIAL MEDIA DOESN'T WORK."

Say it calmly, once, and mean it. This isn't a threat — it's the most credible sentence in the meeting, because it's the only one where you're arguing against your own interest. If he still says no, thank him, leave the sheet, and tell him the offer stands for a fortnight. Then actually stop the unpaid work.

Don'ts

- Don't say "I think" or "maybe" anywhere near the price. "It's two and a half thousand." Full stop.
- Don't apologise for the number, and don't fill the silence after it.
- Don't discount. Every dollar you drop without removing scope tells him the first number was padding.
- Don't promise virality or a booking count. Promise the system, the cadence, and the report.
- Don't pitch in the workshop with cars waiting. Ask for 30 minutes sitting down — a chai, a phone, the sheet.

HONEST CAVEATS

YOUR EYES ONLY

WHAT COULD GO WRONG, AND WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT

- **Five posts a week is a real load for one person.** The two-week buffer isn't a nice-to-have — it's what stops one sick week from breaking the promise. Build it before you need it.
- **Jitty's two videos a week are the weak link.** Give him the ten scripts, a phone tripod, and a Sunday reminder. If he doesn't film, don't let the cadence drop — you fill the gap with photo posts and the inventory video, and you say so in the report.
- **Month two is when he'll doubt it.** Followers move first, leads move later. Your fortnightly report should show leading indicators (views, link taps, profile actions) so the lag doesn't look like failure.
- **The multilingual content needs a native speaker.** If that's not you for Hindi or Punjabi, price a translator into the Dominate tier and keep Malayalam in Grow.
- **The ROI benchmarks above are from measured content programs, mostly B2B and SEO-led.** Use them for the *shape* of the argument (old content keeps working), not as a promise of 300%.

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER YOU PICK THE NUMBER

Once you've decided whether Grow sits at \$2,500 or higher, the Jitty-facing proposal gets built from the **SHOW JITTY** sections of this brief: a one-page cover (what he's received, his numbers, the break-even), the three-option sheet, and a terms page. Two pages he can hold, not a deck.

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- Australian social media management pricing: [CodeQy](#) · [Catalyst Communications](#) · [Ziff Digital](#) · [ReelMonth](#) · [Workspacein SMB report](#)
- Video production and creator rates: [Vidico](#) · [Queen Charles](#) · [Bridge PR UGC guide](#) · [beCreatives](#)
- Auto-repair marketing pricing: [Shop Marketing Pros](#) · [Media Spearhead](#) · [Auto Shop Digital](#)
- Customer value and retention: [DriveLine](#) · [Launch Advisor](#) · [iKon Technologies](#)
- Local search and Google Business Profile: [WiserNotify](#) · [Searchlab](#) · [SeoProfy](#)
- Short-form video: [Vidico](#) · [Kapwing](#)
- Compounding content ROI: [Terakeet](#) · [Genesys Growth](#) · [20North](#)
- Mechanic case study and Australian trust signals: [Ratchet & Wrench on Royalty Auto Service](#) · [Motor1](#) · [AutoGuru Top Mechanics](#) · [Clue](#)
- Multicultural Australia: [Marketing Mag](#) · [CulturalPulse](#) · [Leba](#)
- Marketing budget benchmarks: [Pixelibri](#) · [Boomcycle](#) · [SEEK salary data](#)